



something was wrong back home. I dialled the landline number, and my sister picked up. Usually, she was in college at that time every day. I inquired about everyone in the family, and she told me everything was okay. My heart said she was lying, and I insisted on speaking to our mother and father,” Gupta recalls, suggesting that this was probably his first experience of telepathy, something that yoga might have helped him achieve.

As soon as his family informed him about his father’s illness, he made up his mind to fly back to India, not just for a few days, but to permanently return. He left behind six months of working experience with Fujitsu and six months with AMD (both with Duet Technologies). Most significantly, he was leaving behind a life that many engineers in India still dream of!

“A lot of my friends are settled in the US. I am happily settled in India. What makes me happily settled are both my parents still living with us. My children know what the love of grandparents means. I still get to enjoy a lot of sweets sitting at the same table as my father. I think the day I left the US, my life truly became blessed,” he says, his eyes reflecting deep emotions. And he goes on to explain what truly blessed means!

His father started recovering, and everyone in his family was happy that their son was back home. Pressure began to mount from the family for Gupta to get married. The parents of his wife-to-be visited Gupta’s house and immediately agreed to the match. That’s when Gupta and his future wife began dating on Saturdays. Meanwhile, Duet Technologies was acquired by Motorola, and a big opportunity came knocking on Gupta’s door.

Motorola, as big as Google back



Sanjay Gupta doing Yoga

then, wanted to focus on automotive semiconductors and was keen on setting up a team in India. Gupta, 31 at that time, learned about the interviews that were being held for the position to lead these operations in the country. After waiting for two weeks, he gathered the courage to express his desire to lead the team to his boss.

“I remember my boss telling me that while I had the technological know-how, I might have lacked the business acumen required to run and manage such a team. He turned me down, and the interviews continued,” he shares.

Gupta was so confident about this new venture that he went to his boss asking to be interviewed for the position three times. The third time proved to be the charm, or maybe what Gupta told his boss charmed the latter.

“I wanted to do it; the third time I told my boss, ‘Let me do it. Don’t increase my salary until you are satisfied with the achievements of the vertical.’” He continues, “That’s when I think my words probably charmed my boss!”

Then came the biggest challenge(s)

The opportunity was substantial, but opportunities do not come without their fair share of challenges. Gupta’s interview for leading the new vertical was conducted in the US. He secured the role, and then began a saga of the most significant challenges he had ever faced in his life.

“A lot of my peers in the organisation, who were also very senior to me, did not like that a 31-year-old was given such a prominent role. From corporate politics to various obstacles, I encountered everything once my role was announced. The most significant hurdle was building a new team, a team upon which the success of this new vertical would depend,” he reflects.

As hiring for the vertical took place on a group company basis, Gupta could only get his hands on a handful of resumes. Most of the talented candidates were either hired by other verticals or declined to join a new business unit. “It was like starting a startup within a group. I